

Utku Ceylan

VULNERABILITY RESEARCHER

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PROFILE

Vulnerability researcher focused on Linux systems and Vulnerability research. Discovered and reported a CVSS 9.8 authorization flaw in LiderAhenk (Pardus ecosystem) allowing arbitrary privileged command execution on remote managed systems. Confirmed and patched by the vendor, coordinated with CERT-TR. Nine additional findings submitted under responsible disclosure across the Pardus/ETAP ecosystem, in collaboration with TÜBİTAK BİLGEM (Teknofest Pardus 2026).

EXPERIENCE

Independent Vulnerability Researcher

June 2024 - Present

- Identified a critical authorization vulnerability (CWE-862) in LiderAhenk: the broker enforces no ACL between agents, allowing any authenticated agent to publish commands to another agent's topic. Because credentials can be obtained from installing ahenk agent, this effectively grants unauthenticated remote command execution across managed endpoints.
- Methodology: noticed the agent had no client-side authorization checks and hypothesized the broker might not enforce this either; confirmed it by provisioning a second agent with credentials extracted from a standard ETAP VM, then publishing crafted commands to another agent's pulsar topic.
- Vendor confirmed and remediated; coordinated with CERT-TR; MITRE CVE assignment pending.
- Conducted independent security research on the Pardus ecosystem in collaboration with Pardus and TÜBİTAK BİLGEM teams as part of Teknofest Pardus 2026.
- Submitted 10 security findings affecting the Pardus & ETAP ecosystem via responsible disclosure.

Cybersecurity & Software Team Lead, ThinkTank Software (School Team)

September 2025 - Present

- Lead the technical planning, architecture, and coordination of cybersecurity projects.
- Conduct security research on open-source software and guide vulnerability assessment activities within the team.
- Organize internal CTF events.
- Contribute to the design and development of multiple projects.

PROJECTS

ahenk-debug

Linux diagnostic CLI designed for troubleshooting Pardus ETAP environments. Provides identity validation, broker connectivity testing, service health analysis, ETA API verification, and automated reporting.

Walkie

Python-based p2p encrypted LAN communication platform featuring automatic peer discovery, secure messaging, and voice communication without centralized infrastructure.

Portfolio Website

Interactive portfolio website presenting security research, projects, and technical documentation through a Linux-inspired desktop interface. (linuxizm.website).

HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 vulnerabilities submitted.
- 1 vendor-confirmed vulnerability (MITRE CVE pending)
- Multiple disclosure coordinated with CERT-TR
- Contributor - Teknofest Pardus 2026
- Active in CTF competitions

SKILLS

PROGRAMMING

Python
Shell Script

SECURITY

Vulnerability Research
Linux Security
Access Control Analysis
Dynamic Analysis
Responsible Disclosure
Network/Protocol Analysis

LINUX & SYSTEMS

Linux Internals
System Debugging
Debian Packaging
Linux CLI Development

TOOLS

Git
Docker
GitHub Actions

EDUCATION

Borsa İstanbul Başakşehir Vocational and Technical Anatolian High School

Computer Technologies
İstanbul, Türkiye

LANGUAGES

Turkish Native
English B2 (Upper Intermediate)